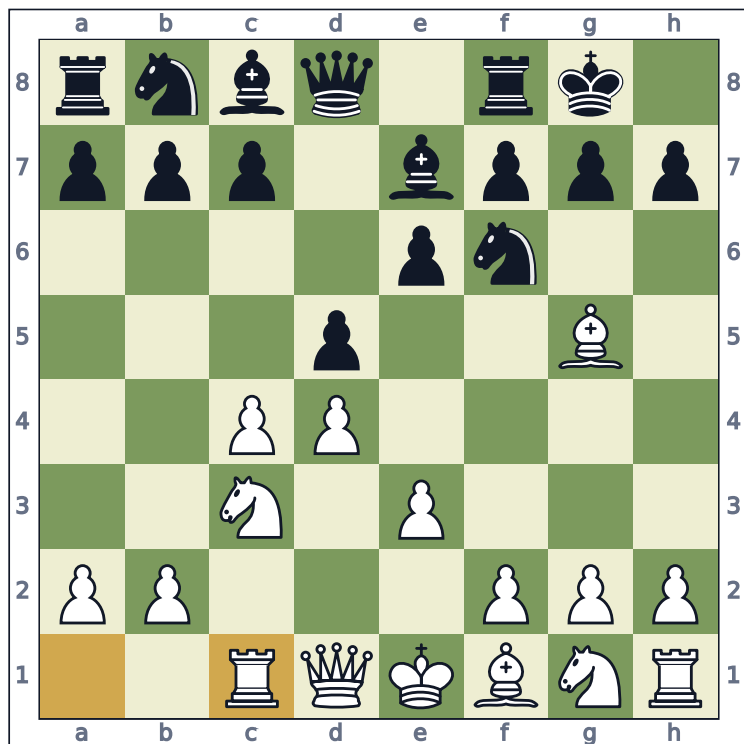


## QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

# Queen's Gambit Declined

ECO D54 | 1 named line in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

## IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

## ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.22 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

## GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

## WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D54 covers Queen's Gambit Declined. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Queen's Gambit Declined: Neo-Orthodox Variation.

## DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 d5 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Rc1

## UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

# What both sides are trying to achieve

**WHITE'S GOALS**

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

**BLACK'S GOALS**

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

**PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING**

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

**PIECE MAP**

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

**WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG**

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. A gambit is a tactical contract: the sacrificed material must buy concrete time, lines, or targets.

**POSITION SNAPSHOT**

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e3, Black pawn on e6.

**WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?**

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

## COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

# Every named D54 line

This section preserves all 1 names and defining routes assigned to D54 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

**001 Queen's Gambit Declined: Neo-Orthodox Variation**

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 d5 4. Bg5 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Rc1